

BEYOND THE TIGER

A monsoon escape to Sariska Lodge reveals pilgrim trails, hidden temples and the quiet joys of Rajasthan's countryside

By Amita Baviskar

After weeks of dealing with seeping walls, car repairs and dental work, I am longing for a break. Anything to get away from daily chores and domestic crises. So, I gladly seize the weekend invitation from Sariska Lodge and off we drive at dawn from Delhi towards Alwar, Rajasthan. Past the purgatory of Gurugram's traffic snarls, we bowl along the Delhi-Mumbai expressway before turning off onto a small road that winds its way between villages and fields full of bajra, climbing into the forested Aravalli hills. The cacophony of city life falls away. Here is a slower pace, serenity, and space to breathe.